

MICHELE VALINOTI

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY

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Education

PhD and MPhil in Economics , , New York University, USA	2020 – 2026
MA in Economics , <i>Allievi Honors Program</i> , Collegio Carlo Alberto, Italy	2015 – 2019
MSc in Stochastics and Data Science , <i>cum laude</i> , University of Turin, Italy	2017 – 2019
BSc in Physics , <i>cum laude</i> , University of Turin, Italy	2014 – 2017

Research and Professional Experience

Jun – Aug 2025	Uber , PhD Scientist Intern (Membership Team). <i>San Francisco, USA</i>
May 2024 – Jan 2025	NYU , Research Assistant for Prof. Bryant Moy (NYU, Politics). <i>New York, USA</i>
May 2022 – Aug 2023	NBER , Research Assistant for Prof. Giulia Brancaccio (NYU Stern, Economics) & Prof. Karam Kang (UW-Madison, Economics). <i>New York, USA</i>
Jan – Jul 2020	European Central Bank , Risk Analyst Intern. <i>Frankfurt, Germany</i>

Teaching Experience

Fall 2025	Money & Banking (UG), NYU, Course Assistant
Spring 2024 – 2025	Statistics (UG), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2023 – 2024	Math for Economists (MA), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Summer 2024 – 2025	Industrial Organization (UG), NYU, Course Assistant
Spring 2023	Microeconomics (MA), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2022	Game Theory (PHD), NYU, Course Assistant

Awards and Scholarships

2020 – 2025	Henry Mitchell MacCracken Fellowship, NYU
2023	CV Starr Center for Applied Economics Data Purchase Support, NYU
2016 – 2019	Allievi Honors Program Scholarship, Collegio Carlo Alberto

Skills

Coding: Python (*pandas*, *scikit-learn*, *PyTorch*, *Hugging Face*), Julia, R, SQL**Tools:** Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, PySpark**Languages:** English (fluent), Italian (native)

Research Projects

The Market for Political Access. Evidence from New York State Lobbying

We study how commercial lobbying firms intermediate access to lawmakers when political attention is scarce. We use a novel dataset of New York State lobbying that links who contacted whom, through which intermediary, and on behalf of which client, to administrative records on grants and contracts received by tax-exempt organizations. We document that meetings are highly concentrated on a small set of powerful legislators and that commercial lobbying firms mediate a disproportionate share of contacts to these lawmakers, leveraging often revolving-door ties and connections proxied by campaign contributions. Guided by these facts, we develop and estimate a two-stage model of access allocation. In the first stage, clients choose whether to lobby and whether to do so in-house, through a commercial lobbying firm, or jointly. In the second stage, politicians allocate meetings across client-lobbyist pairs subject to legislator-specific capacity. The estimates imply strongly diminishing returns to additional access and sizable entry costs, and model-based counterfactual simulations suggest that eliminating commercial lobbying firms, or reallocating their relationship capital, would modestly reduce aggregate nonprofit grants while meaningfully changing their distribution, especially for large organizations.

Criminal Activity Nuisance Ordinance (CANO) Database (with Bryant Moy and Moin Khan)

Criminal Activity Nuisance Ordinances (CANOs) are local policies that allow governments to designate properties and residents as nuisances after repeated interactions with the police. Research across disciplines highlights that CANOs disproportionately impact people of color, economically disadvantaged communities, and victims of crime, often arising from discriminatory or racially motivated considerations. However, the absence of a comprehensive, nationwide dataset restricts systematic analysis of their prevalence and broader social implications.

We address this gap by constructing the first national database of CANOs, using large language models to classify municipal ordinances at scale and to extract key attributes such as adoption year and the strength of eviction provisions. We document that CANOs are geographically widespread and adopted in a concave relation with minority population shares, consistent with racial-threat dynamics. Linking the database to eviction and crime records, We find that CANO adoption is associated with higher eviction and threatened-eviction rates – especially where ordinances mandate or strongly encourage eviction – but has no detectable effect on overall crime or arrest rates, including juvenile, Black, and Hispanic arrests.

Women, Media and Politics (with Sahar Parsa)

This paper investigates the persistent gender disparities in media coverage of political candidates in the United States from 1980 to 2021. Using a novel dataset that combines detailed electoral records with over one million newspaper articles, we provide a comprehensive analysis of how female and male candidates are represented in the media during election campaigns for congressional, gubernatorial, and mayoral offices. We show that, conditional on running, women are at least as visible as men and often receive more article-level coverage, but that the content and tone of coverage differ systematically by gender, even after controlling for incumbency, office, and party. Methodologically, we introduce an embedding-based representation of candidate-specific text and decompose male-female separation into components associated with topical emphasis and stylistic treatment.

References

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